SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #1 · SCARCITY AND SECURITY

"There will never be enough."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Growing up with real shortage, hearing worry about bills at the table, going without, or living through a layoff or a lean season can teach the body to expect "not enough." Even after things improve, the alarm can keep ringing. Constant messages to buy more, have more, and keep up can also make any amount feel small.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not pretend that need is unreal. It records hunger, drought, and poverty. But it consistently teaches that God knows what we need and provides, often day by day. Israel gathered manna and found there was enough for each person. Jesus told us not to be consumed with worry about food and clothing, because our Father knows. These passages do not promise riches, and they do not say a person in need has done something wrong. They invite trust, wise stewardship, and the use of the help God provides through work, family, church, and community.

> *"And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus"* (Philippians 4:19).

Also see

> "The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want" (Psalm 23:1).

> "Therefore do not worry, saying, 'What shall we eat?' or 'What shall we drink?' or 'What shall we wear?' For the Gentiles strive after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them. But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things will be added unto you" (Matthew 6:31–33).

> "When they measured it by the omer, he who gathered much had no excess, and he who gathered little had no shortfall. Each one gathered as much as he needed to eat" (Exodus 16:18).

> "And God is able to make all grace abound to you, so that in all things, at all times, having all that you need, you will abound in every good work" (2 Corinthians 9:8).

Common self-statements

- No matter what I earn, it will not be enough.
- There is always another bill around the corner.
- If I relax, I will run out.
- Other people have enough; I never do.
- I cannot enjoy anything because I might need the money later.
- Good times never last.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always run short.
- Catastrophizing: Treating every unexpected expense as the start of ruin.
- Mental filter: Noticing what is missing and overlooking what I do have.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that if I am not fully secure, I am completely without.

Challenging questions

- What exactly do I need right now, and is it covered today?
- When have I feared running out and then found that a need was met?
- What would "enough" look like in numbers, and have I ever written it down?
- Where did I first learn to expect that there would never be enough?
- Is this a present shortage, or an old alarm that has not shut off?
- What is one small step I can take this week toward wise planning?

Truth summary

> Some seasons are hard, and some needs are real. But "never enough" is a prediction, not a fact. God knows what I need and has met my needs before. I can plan wisely, accept help, and take one day at a time, trusting the One who provides.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Money
- Poverty
- Riches, True
- Anxiety/Worry
- God, All Powerful

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Money/Riches
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Good Good Father — Chris Tomlin
God's fatherly love is deeper than human approval or achievement.

Do It Again — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's repeated gifts and new mercies express His continuing love.

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "There will never be enough"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"There will never be enough." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I actually need today?
- ☐ When has a need been met after I worried?
- ☐ What would "enough" look like in real numbers?
- ☐ Is this a present shortage or an old alarm?
- ☐ What small step can I take this week?
- ☐ Who could I ask for help?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I have what I need for today.
- ☐ Planning is wise; panic is not.
- ☐ God has met my needs before and I can trust Him again.
- ☐ Enough does not have to mean plenty.
- ☐ I can ask for help without shame.
- ☐ I can be thankful and prepared at the same time.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Philippians 4:19**
  "And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ **Psalm 23:1**
  "The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want."
- ☐ **Matthew 6:31–33**
  "Therefore do not worry, saying, 'What shall we eat?' or 'What shall we drink?' or 'What shall we wear?' For the Gentiles strive after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them. But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things will be added unto you."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What I had and what I needed: Each evening, write one need that was met today and one worry about tomorrow. Note whether the worry came true.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Philippians 4:19 becomes: "Sarah can write: "My God will supply what I need, and I can take one wise step today.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Riches, True" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Write a simple "enough" list. List what you need monthly for food, housing, and transportation. Compare it with what you have. Note any gap honestly.
- [ ] Name three needs God has met in the past. Write them down. Read the list when worry rises.
- [ ] Make one small, realistic plan. Choose one step, such as a short budget, a call to a creditor, or setting aside a small amount, and do it this week.
- [ ] Practice thanks. At each meal this week, name one thing you have. Notice whether the feeling of scarcity changes even a little.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "There will never be enough": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A need that was met
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~There will never be enough.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You know what I need before I ask. Quiet the alarm inside me that says there will never be enough. Help me plan wisely, receive help, and trust You for today. Thank You that You provide. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #2 · SCARCITY AND SECURITY

“Anything I have could vanish tomorrow.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

A sudden loss of a job, a home, a loved one, or savings can teach us that nothing is safe. A parent who lost everything, or who lived in constant fear of loss, may have passed that fear along without a word. After a hard blow, the mind tries to protect us by expecting the next one.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is honest that earthly things can be lost. Jesus said moth, rust, and thieves can destroy what we store up on earth, and He pointed us to treasure that cannot be taken. God also gives a promise that does not depend on what we own: He will never leave us or forsake us. These verses do not say we will never lose anything. They say that what matters most is held securely, and that God is with us through every loss.

> *“Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, for God has said: ‘Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.’”* (Hebrews 13:5).

Also see

> “Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust destroy, and where thieves break in and steal. But store up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where moth and rust do not destroy, and where thieves do not break in and steal. For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also” (Matthew 6:19–21).

> “God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble. Therefore we will not fear, though the earth is transformed and the mountains are toppled into the depths of the seas” (Psalm 46:1–2).

> “The LORD is my chosen portion and my cup; You have made my lot secure” (Psalm 16:5).

> “When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you go through the rivers, they will not overwhelm you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be scorched; the flames will not set you ablaze” (Isaiah 43:2).

Common self-statements

- Whatever I build can be taken away.
- I cannot let myself get comfortable.
- Just when things are good, something will happen.
- I should not get attached to anything.
- Having less means losing less.
- Safety is an illusion.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting loss before anything has happened.
- Overgeneralizing: Turning one painful loss into “everything is at risk.”
- Catastrophizing: Treating a possible loss as certain and unbearable.
- Discounting the positive: Dismissing what is stable and secure right now.

Challenging questions

- What loss did I live through, and am I treating today as if it were that day?
- What, right now, is secure and likely to stay?
- If I did lose something, what has God given me to get through it?
- What is the difference between being careful and living in dread?
- What can I not lose, according to Scripture?
- Who could stand with me in a hard time?

Truth summary

> Possessions and circumstances can change, and some losses are real. But I am not alone, and what matters most is held by God. I can be careful without living in dread, and enjoy what I have today without fearing every tomorrow.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Refuge/Safety
- Protection
- Riches, Beware of
- Trust
- Fear

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Trouble/Hardship
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Whom Shall I Fear — Chris Tomlin
God's presence provides courage without requiring a life free of difficulty.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Turn Your Eyes Upon Jesus — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn directs attention to Christ when fear or earthly concerns dominate.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Anything I have could vanish tomorrow"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Anything I have could vanish tomorrow." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What loss am I still reacting to?
- ☐ What is secure today?
- ☐ What has God given me to cope with loss?
- ☐ How can I be careful without dread?
- ☐ What treasure cannot be taken?
- ☐ Who can stand with me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God is with me, whatever happens to my things.
- ☐ I can enjoy what I have today.
- ☐ Being careful is wise; dread is not.
- ☐ My most important treasure cannot be taken.
- ☐ I have survived hard things before.
- ☐ I do not face loss alone.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Hebrews 13:5**
  "Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, for God has said: 'Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.'"
- ☐ **Matthew 6:19–21**
  "Do not store up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust destroy, and where thieves break in and steal. But store up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where moth and rust do not destroy, and where thieves do not break in and steal. For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also."
- ☐ **Psalm 46:1–2**
  "God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble. Therefore we will not fear, though the earth is transformed and the mountains are toppled into the depths of the seas."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What is secure today: Each day, write down one thing that is secure and one fear about loss. Rate your fear from 0 to 10 and note any change.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Hebrews 13:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God will never leave me, so I can enjoy today without dread.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Refuge/Safety" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Make a short "what is secure" list. Include people, faith, health, skills, and savings. Read it when fear about loss rises.
- [ ] Take one practical protective step. Update a document, review insurance, or back up important files. Then stop and rest.
- [ ] Enjoy one thing without fear. Spend ten minutes enjoying something you have, such as a meal or a walk, and notice the fear without following it.
- [ ] Tell one trusted person about a fear of loss. Notice how it feels to share it.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Anything I have could vanish tomorrow": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Something secure
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Anything I have could vanish tomorrow.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You know the losses I have carried. Hold me when I fear more. Help me enjoy what You have given, and remind me that You will never leave me or forsake me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #3 · SCARCITY AND SECURITY

"I must hold on to everything."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When money, food, or comfort were scarce, holding on tightly was how a family survived. Saving everything, never wasting, and never letting go can feel like the only safe way. A person may also have been shamed for spending or giving, or may have lived through a loss that taught them to guard what is left.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture honors saving, planning, and care for what we own. It also warns that life does not consist in the abundance of possessions, and that gripping what we have can crowd out trust. God tells us to be generous and to put our hope in Him, not in uncertain wealth. Giving does not mean being careless; it means holding things with an open hand, trusting that God is our source and that generosity is part of how He refreshes us.

> *"And He said to them, 'Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions.'"* (Luke 12:15).

Also see

> "Do not be afraid, little flock, for your Father is pleased to give you the kingdom" (Luke 12:32).

> "Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy. Instruct them to do good, to be rich in good works, and to be generous and ready to share, treasuring up for themselves a firm foundation for the future, so that they may take hold of that which is truly life" (1 Timothy 6:17–19).

> "One gives freely, yet gains even more; another withholds what is right, only to become poor. A generous soul will prosper, and he who refreshes others will himself be refreshed" (Proverbs 11:24–25).

> "In everything, I showed you that by this kind of hard work we must help the weak, remembering the words of the Lord Jesus Himself: 'It is more blessed to give than to receive.'" (Acts 20:35).

Common self-statements

- If I let go of anything, I will regret it.
- I might need it someday.
- Throwing things out is wasteful and dangerous.
- I cannot give; I need everything I have.
- Letting go means losing.
- If I hold on tight enough, I will stay safe.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will need exactly what I let go.
- Catastrophizing: Treating letting go of a small thing as a threat to survival.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that I must keep everything or risk losing everything.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling anxious when I let go and concluding that it is dangerous.

Challenging questions

- What am I afraid will happen if I let something go?
- How often have I actually needed an item I kept "just in case"?
- What has holding on cost me in space, peace, or relationships?
- What did I learn early in life about keeping and losing?
- Where does Scripture connect trust with open hands?
- What is one small thing I could release or share this week?
- What would I tell a friend who felt this way?

Truth summary

> Saving and caring for what I have is wise. But I do not have to hold on to everything to be safe. My security comes from God, not from what I keep. I can hold things with an open hand, share when I am able, and let go of what I do not need.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Greedy/Stingy
- Giving
- Riches, Beware of
- Money
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Money/Riches
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Even If — MercyMe
Trust in God need not depend on receiving the particular miracle we want.

Greater — MercyMe
God's presence and grace challenge shame and the need to win everyone's approval.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I must hold on to everything"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I must hold on to everything." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I fear will happen if I let go?
- ☐ How often have I needed what I kept?
- ☐ What has holding on cost me?
- ☐ What did I learn early about keeping and losing?
- ☐ What small thing could I release?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My safety comes from God, not from what I keep.
- ☐ I can save wisely and still let go.
- ☐ Giving can bring peace, not only loss.
- ☐ I do not need to keep everything "just in case."
- ☐ Letting go of small things is a safe practice.
- ☐ An open hand is not a careless hand.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Luke 12:15**
  "And He said to them, 'Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions.'"
- ☐ **1 Timothy 6:17–19**
  "Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy. Instruct them to do good, to be rich in good works, and to be generous and ready to share, treasuring up for themselves a firm foundation for the future, so that they may take hold of that which is truly life."
- ☐ **Proverbs 11:24–25**
  "One gives freely, yet gains even more; another withholds what is right, only to become poor. A generous soul will prosper, and he who refreshes others will himself be refreshed."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What I kept and what I released: Record one thing you let go of or shared, your fear before from 0 to 10, and what actually happened.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Luke 12:15 becomes: "Sarah can write: "My life is more than what I keep, and God is my source.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Giving" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Release one small, low-risk item. Choose something you have not used in a year. Predict how upsetting it will be from 0 to 10, let it go, and record what happened.
- [ ] Share something small. Give a small amount of time, food, or money. Notice the fear and what you feel afterward.
- [ ] Set a "keep" rule. Decide in advance what is worth keeping, such as important papers or sentimental items, so the rest is easier to release.
- [ ] Pray with open hands. Hold your hands open for one minute and thank God that He is your source.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I must hold on to everything": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One thing released
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I must hold on to everything.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You know why I hold so tightly. Teach me to trust You as my provider. Help me keep what is wise, release what I do not need, and give with an open hand. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #4 · SCARCITY AND SECURITY

"Asking for help means I've failed."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Families that prized independence, or that were ashamed of needing anything, can teach children that asking is weakness. A person who asked for help and was refused, mocked, or made to feel indebted may stop asking altogether. Pride in self-reliance can also grow from a real history of having to cope alone.

What Scripture teaches

God made us to need one another. Scripture tells us to carry each other's burdens, and it shows even Moses, a great leader, being told that the task was too heavy for him to handle alone. We are invited to come to God's throne of grace for help in our time of need, and Paul learned that God's power is shown in weakness. Asking for help is not failure; it is how God's design for community works.

> *"Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ"* (Galatians 6:2).

Also see

> "But Moses' father-in-law said to him, 'What you are doing is not good. Surely you and these people with you will wear yourselves out, because the task is too heavy for you. You cannot handle it alone.'" (Exodus 18:17–18).

> "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need" (Hebrews 4:16).

> "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me" (2 Corinthians 12:9).

> "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!" (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

Common self-statements

- A capable person handles it alone.
- If I ask, people will think less of me.
- I should not need anyone.
- Needing help proves I could not cope.
- I do not want to owe anyone.
- Other people never struggle like this.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either fully independent or a failure.
- Mind reading: Assuming others will judge me for asking.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should never need help.
- Mislabeling: Calling a normal need a personal failure.

Challenging questions

- When someone asks me for help, do I think less of them?

- What happened in the past when I asked for help?
- What has handling everything alone cost me?
- Who has helped me before, and how did it feel to be helped?
- What does Scripture say about carrying one another's burdens?
- What is one small request I could make this week?
- What would I want a friend to do if they were in my shoes?

Truth summary

> Asking for help is not failure. God designed us to help one another, and even strong leaders in Scripture needed help. Needing help does not make me less. I can ask wisely and kindly, receive with thanks, and offer help in return.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Help
- Friendship
- Church
- Humility
- Strength

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Communication

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Asking for help means I've failed"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Asking for help means I've failed." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ When others ask me for help, do I think less of them?
- ☐ What happened when I asked before?
- ☐ What has handling everything alone cost me?
- ☐ Who could I ask this week?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?
- ☐ What small request can I make?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Needing help does not mean I have failed.
- ☐ God made us to carry burdens together.
- ☐ Asking for help is a sign of wisdom.
- ☐ I can receive help and still be capable.
- ☐ Most people are glad to help when they can.
- ☐ I can ask and let the other person decide.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Galatians 6:2**
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ **Hebrews 4:16**
  "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need."
- ☐ **Ecclesiastes 4:9–10**
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What I asked and what happened: Write down one request, your fear beforehand from 0 to 10, how the person responded, and how you felt afterward.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Galatians 6:2 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God made us to carry burdens together, so I can ask for help.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Help" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Make one small request. Ask a safe person for a ride, a bit of advice, or help with a task. Record what happened.
- [ ] Name your support team. List three people or groups you could turn to, such as family, friends, church, or a counselor.
- [ ] Seek one practical resource. If money is tight, look up a local assistance service, food program, or church benevolence fund, and note what is available.
- [ ] Thank someone who helped you. Tell them what the help meant, and notice that receiving can be a gift to the giver too.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie “Asking for help means I’ve failed”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A request I made
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Asking for help means I’ve failed.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD’S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You know how hard it is for me to ask. Heal the places where asking brought shame. Show me safe people, help me ask with humility, and teach me that needing others is part of Your design. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #5 · SCARCITY AND SECURITY

"Life is never stable or safe."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Childhood in an unpredictable home, repeated moves, a frightening event, or growing up around constant financial strain can teach the mind that the ground is never solid. When hardship comes often, the nervous system learns to stay on guard, and it can begin to feel as if danger is always near.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not promise a life without trouble. Jesus said that in the world we will have tribulation, but that we can take courage because He has overcome the world. God is called our refuge and an ever-present help in trouble. The Bible also invites us to lie down and sleep in peace because God makes us dwell in safety. These verses speak of a steadiness that rests on God, even when circumstances shake.

> *"God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble. Therefore we will not fear, though the earth is transformed and the mountains are toppled into the depths of the seas"* (Psalm 46:1–2).

Also see

> "I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety" (Psalm 4:8).

> "Do not fear sudden danger or the ruin that overtakes the wicked, for the LORD will be your confidence and will keep your foot from the snare" (Proverbs 3:25–26).

> "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You" (Isaiah 26:3).

> "I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!" (John 16:33).

Common self-statements

- Something bad is always about to happen.
- I can never relax.
- Nothing in life can be counted on.
- I have to stay on guard all the time.
- Safety is for other people.
- Just when things settle down, they fall apart.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Turning past instability into "life is always unsafe."
- Fortune telling: Expecting trouble that has not come.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling on edge and concluding that I am in danger.
- Mental filter: Noticing threats while overlooking what is steady.

Challenging questions

- What in my past taught me that life is unstable?

- What, right now, is stable and safe?
- Am I in danger at this moment, or is my body reacting to an old alarm?
- What has God provided in past hard times?
- What does it mean to find refuge in God, not in perfect circumstances?
- What is one small routine I could build that adds stability?
- Who could I talk with if I feel unsafe?

Truth summary

> Life has real uncertainty, and I cannot control everything. But "never stable or safe" is not the whole truth. There are steady things today, and God is my refuge and help in trouble. I can build small routines, trust Him for what I cannot control, and rest.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Refuge/Safety
- Protection
- Peace
- Trust
- Fear

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Trouble/Hardship
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Fear Is a Liar — Zach Williams
Examine fear-driven accusations rather than treating them as reliable truth.

Same Power — Jeremy Camp
God's power challenges the belief that evil or fear has the final authority.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Life is never stable or safe"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Life is never stable or safe." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What taught me that life is unstable?
- ☐ What is steady today?
- ☐ Am I in danger now, or reacting to an old alarm?
- ☐ What has God provided before?
- ☐ What routine could add stability?
- ☐ Who can I talk to?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God is my refuge, even when life shakes.
- ☐ Some things in my life are steady.
- ☐ I can build small routines that give stability.
- ☐ Feeling on edge does not prove I am in danger.
- ☐ I have gotten through hard times before.
- ☐ I can rest in God's care tonight.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 46:1–2
  "God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble. Therefore we will not fear, though the earth is transformed and the mountains are toppled into the depths of the seas."
- ☐ Psalm 4:8
  "I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety."
- ☐ Isaiah 26:3
  "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

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PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What was steady today: Each evening, write one thing that was stable or safe today and rate how safe you felt from 0 to 10.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Psalm 4:8 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God makes me dwell in safety, so I can rest tonight.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Peace" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

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- [ ] Build one steady routine. Choose a regular wake-up, meal, or evening routine and keep it for a week.
- [ ] Name what is safe right now. Look around and name five things that are safe in this moment. Breathe slowly while you do.
- [ ] Talk to one trusted person. Share one fear about safety and notice how it feels to be heard.
- [ ] Read a refuge verse aloud. Read Psalm 46:1–2 or Psalm 4:8 slowly each night this week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Life is never stable or safe": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Something steady
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My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Life is never stable or safe.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You are my refuge and strength. When my life feels shaky, steady my heart. Help me find rest in Your care, build small steadiness into my days, and trust You with what I cannot control. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.